

Sarah S. Salas

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Education

Current	University of Wisconsin-Madison • PhD Candidate • Minor: Data Science and Quantitative Analysis • Preliminary Exams: Demography, Social Stratification • Dissertation Title: Place and Perceptions: How stress, place, and migration shape health and aging
2024	University of Wisconsin-Madison • Sociology, M.S.
2019	University of Texas at Austin • Chemistry, BSA • Minor: French • Certificate: Ethics and Leadership in Health Care

Research Interests

Inequalities in health and mortality; Discrimination; Health across the life course; Epigenetics; Residential histories

Publications

Xu, W., Engelman, M., Malecki, K., Kamis, C., Schultz, A., Agnew, M., **Salas, S.**, 2024
Respond to “Improving spatial exposure data for everyone: lifecourse social context and
ascertaining residential history”. *American Journal of Epidemiology*

Xu, W., Kamis, C., Agnew, M., Schultz, A., **Salas, S.**, Malecki, K., Engelman, M., 2024 The
health implications of cumulative exposure to contextual (dis)advantage: Methodological and
substantive advances from a unique data linkage. *American Journal of Epidemiology*
<https://doi.org/10.1093/aje/kwae183>

Xu, W., Kamis, C., Agnew, M., Schultz, A., **Salas, S.**, Malecki, K., Engelman, M. 2023.
Constructing Residential Histories in a General Population-Based Representative Sample.
American Journal of Epidemiology <https://doi.org/10.1093/aje/kwad188>

Ouayogodé, M., **Salas, S.** 2023. Experienced Racism and Discrimination and Psychological Distress Amid Different Phases of the COVID-19 Pandemic: Evidence from Wisconsin. *Journal of Racial and Ethnic Health Disparities* <https://doi.org/10.1007/s40615-023-01782-4>

Work in Progress

Salas, S., Engelman, M., Regional Patterns in the Prevalence and Health Consequences of Perceived Discrimination (in progress)

Salas, S., Engelman, M., Clark, J., Xu, W., Schultz, A., Malecki, K., Does Perceived Discrimination or Stress Appraisal Matter More for Epigenetic Aging? (in progress)

Nunez, J.*, **Salas, S.***, Engelman, M., Mechanisms of Latino Migrant Retention: Lived-In Experiences from the Third Age and Implications for Health. (in progress)

Ouayogodé, M., **Salas, S.**, The Impact of COVID-19 on Employment Changes and their Effect on Mental Well-being. (in progress)

* Indicates equal first co-authorship

Awards and Scholarships

2025 Travel Stipend – Genomics for Social Scientists – Epigenetics Workshop (\$1,000)
2024 Emerging Scholars Poster Winner – International Conference on Aging in the Americas
2024 Departmental Graduate Student Travel Award (\$800)
2024 CDHA Travel Award (\$2,000)
2023 Poster Award Winner – PAA Annual Meeting
2021 NIA T32 training grant fellowship (through 2023)

Teaching and Research Experience

Spring 2024 Teaching Assistant for Soc 357, Methods of Sociological Inquiry (Instructor: Chaeyoon Lim)

Invited Talks

2023 Perceived Discrimination in Wisconsin: Findings and Current and Future Work. Brauer Group Lab, Department of Psychology University of Wisconsin-Madison; Madison, WI.

Presentations at Professional Meetings

2026 Aging into a New Place: How Older Latino Immigrants in Wisconsin Interpret Prior U.S. Destinations. Population Association of America. St. Louis, MO
2026 Regional Patterns in the Prevalence and Health Consequences of Perceived Discrimination. Population Association of America. St. Louis, MO
2026 Neighborhood Characteristics and Trajectories of Functional Limitations Among Older Adults. Population Association of America. St. Louis, MO

- 2024 Mechanisms of Latino Migrant Retention: Lived-In Experiences from the Third Age and Implications for Health. International Conference on Aging in the Americas. Austin, TX.
- 2024 Everyday and Lifetime Discrimination: Examining Variation in Epigenetic Aging Among Three Clocks. Interdisciplinary Association for Population Health Science. St. Louis, MO.
- 2024 Panethnic Identity Formation and Navigation Among Older Latino Immigrants in Wisconsin. American Sociological Association. Montreal, Canada.
- 2024 Does Epigenetic Age Vary by Perceived Discrimination? An Analysis of Three Clocks. American Sociological Association. Montreal, Canada.
- 2024 Employment Security and Psychological Distress during the COVID-19 Pandemic: Evidence from Wisconsin. American Society of Health Economists. San Diego, CA.
- 2024 The Role of Health in Racial Classification and Identification in Mid-Life. Population Association of America. Columbus, OH.
- 2024 Employment Loss During COVID-19: Assessing How the Impact on Well-being Changed Since the Start of the Pandemic. Population Association of America. Columbus, OH
- 2024 Perceived Discrimination and Biological Aging Across Three Epigenetic Clocks. Population Association of America. Columbus, OH.
- 2023 The Role of Health in Racial Classification and Identification in Mid-Life. Southern Demographic Association. San Antonio, TX.
- 2023 Perceived Discrimination in Wisconsin: Who Reports It and Does It Matter for Health? American Sociological Association (roundtable). Philadelphia, PA.
- 2023 Perceived Racial Discrimination and Mental Well-being Amid the COVID-19 Pandemic: Evidence from Wisconsin. Population Association of America (flash). New Orleans, LA.
- 2023 Discrimination and Health in the Upper Midwest. Poster Population Association of America. New Orleans, LA
- 2022 Discrimination and Health in the Midwest: Comparative Results from SHOW and MIDUS. Synergies in Longitudinal Studies Conference. Madison, WI.
- 2022 Constructing Residential Histories to Examine Life Course Contextual Exposure in a Geographically Diverse Sample. Population Association of America. Atlanta, GA.
- 2022 Life course cumulative exposure to contextual disadvantage and health: Evidence from the SHOW study. Population Association of America, Atlanta, GA.

- 2021 Residential Histories in Urban and Rural Places: Quantifying the Impact of Neighborhood Exposures on Population Health in Wisconsin (flash). Population Association of America, (online).
- 2021 Assessing immigration-related family conflict: Initial scale development and testing (paper symposium). Society for Research in Child Development, (online).

Other Training

2025 Genomics for Social Scientists – Epigenetics Workshop, University of Michigan

Service

2025 Student member, search committee, UW-Madison Sociology Department

2023-2025 Student representative, BIPOC Recruitment and Retention Committee, UW-Madison Sociology Department

2025 Session chair at PAA oral sessions, Washington, DC

2023 Session chair at Southern Demographic Association meeting paper session, San Antonio, TX

2023 Table Presider at ASA Roundtable, Philadelphia, PA

2022-2024 Graduate student mentor to incoming graduate students

Professional Associations

Population Association of America; American Sociological Association; Southern Demographic Association; Interdisciplinary Association for Population Health Science ; Gerontological Society of America

Skills

Languages: Spanish (fluent), French (basic)

Computing: Stata, R, Microsoft Office